CHICAGO PARK DISTRICT

PARTNERSHIPS - ARCS PROGRAM

INTRODUCTION

The Chicago Park District welcomes and encourages partnerships that enhance and support our mission and programs. The mission of the Chicago Park District is to:

To give people of all ages, identities, and abilities access to quality recreation, wellness opportunities, and sustainable green spaces in every neighborhood.

OVERVIEW

ARCS partners and the Chicago Park District develop a mutually beneficial agreement that outlines programs and activities based on a rigorous proposal process. The process assesses the merits of the proposed activities for the Park District and determines to what extent the activities further the Park District's mission. If it is determined that there is significant value of the program to the Park District, ARCS partners may eligible for special ARCS fees, as outlined in the program guidelines.

This form is to be used to *establish or renew* a formal partnership agreement with individuals, businesses, nonprofits, or other community groups. Eligible programs include:

- **Athletic:** youth sport leagues, private schools use of athletic space
- **Resident:** nonprofits, associations, or agency seeking space to provide regular, ongoing programming that aligns with CPD's mission
- **Contractor:** organizations or businesses seeking to provide ***fee-based programs*** that align with CPD's mission.
- **Service Provider:** partner seeking to provide programs for park-driven programs and events for ***no fee for participants.***

All partners are required to provide proof of insurance. An application will not be considered complete without a Certificate of Insurance that names the Chicago Park District as additional insured.

- Proof of insurance: Please send a COI naming the Chicago Park District as additional insured. Please use our main address, 4830 S Western Ave, Chicago, IL 60609, for this purpose.

If approved, you will be notified and sent a partnership agreement outlining the activities, benefits, and payment required to proceed with the partnership.

Once completed, submit this form to partnerships.app@chicagoparkdistrict.com. Please allow a minimum of 30 days to approve your proposal. Some proposed activities may require more time to plan and approve.

TODAY'S DATE	ORGANIZATION NAME (AS LISTED ON THE COI)
10/16/2026	Ras Tafari Inc.
MAILING ADDRESS	WEBSITE
7700 S. Stony Island Ave., Chicago, IL 60649	selassiefest.com/full-spectrum/
CEO/OWNER NAME	CEO/OWNER PHONE
Stephen Henry, President	(872) 255-9333
CEO/OWNER EMAIL	
stephen@selassiefest.com	
CONTACT NAME	CONTACT PHONE
Stephen Henry	(872) 255-9333
CONTACT EMAIL	
stephen@selassiefest.com	

PARTNERSHIP NAME (PROGRAM/SERVICE/EVENT SERIES NAME)

Full Spectrum at Rainbow Beach

TYPE OF PARTNERSHIP REQUESTED

Service Provider

Is your organization a 501c3 nonprofit, business, individual, or other community group?

(●) 501c3 nonprofit ( ) Business ( ) Individual ( ) Other Community Group

Do you have an existing relationship with a PAC, local park, or department of the Chicago Park District? If yes please list the name and title of your contact. Yes. Ivry Ector, Park Supervisor, Rainbow Beach Park

Brief Description of the Organization/Individual and the Purpose of the Proposed Partnership. (How do you describe your organization/self and this program in marketing materials and/or outreach?) 50 Words or Less.

Ras Tafari Inc. is a Chicago 501(c)(3) cultural and educational nonprofit and the producer of SelassieFest. Full Spectrum is our free, year-round music and culture program for Rainbow Beach Park: DJ classes, Rainbow Wednesdays youth DJ nights, live stage shows, festival days and fall and holiday family parties.

How does this proposed partnership align with or support the Chicago Park District mission? 50 Words or Less.

It gives people of all ages, identities and abilities free, quality arts and recreation in their own neighborhood park. South Shore families get the kind of music programming they now travel nine miles to Grant Park for, with free classes, loaned gear, ASL interpretation and accessible seating.

IMPACT AREA. Select all that apply. **Ctrl+Click**

- Arts/Culture
- Education
- Life Skills
- Recreation

Will your activities be open to the public? (●) Yes ( ) No

If no, please explain your process for how participants gain involvement in your activity.

PARK(S) WHERE PARTNERSHIP WILL TAKE PLACE:

Rainbow Beach Park, 3111 E. 77th St.

PROGRAM START DATE

1/1/27

PROGRAM END DATE

12/31/27

FACILITIES REQUESTED. SELECT ALL THAT APPLY.

Gymnasium - General	Outdoor Space - Other	Rooms - Dance
Gymnasium - Large	Rooms - Club	Rooms - Other

Please enter the total number of hours needed per day below.

SUN	MON	TUES	WED	THURS	FRI	SAT
			4			3

FOR MORE INFORMATION ABOUT THE SCHEDULE PLEASE DESCRIBE BELOW OR ATTACH A CALENDAR

Rainbow Wednesdays, on the beach (Outdoor Space - Other): 14 Wednesdays, June 2 to Sept. 1, 2027, 6:00 to 8:30 pm (5:00 to 9:00 pm with setup). DJ classes: one 90-minute class a week, day and room set with park staff. Black History Month: four Saturdays in Feb. Stage shows, festival days and holiday parties on dates set with park staff, each with its own permit. Calendar attached.

ARE YOU REQUESTING MARKETING MATERIAL POSTED IN THE PARK? SELECT ALL THAT APPLY.

Banners	Flyers	Other

OTHER PARK RESOURCES

Other marketing: online via Rainbow Beach Park & CPD; power, tables, chairs

Will you charge a fee for activities? ( ) Yes (●) No

If yes, please describe fee and amount.

Do any of your planned activities require a Special Event Permit? (●) Yes ( ) No

Are you requesting a discount for the Special Event Permit? (●) Yes ( ) No

Outline your activities in detail. Please include a description of the program, the purpose of the partnership, and how these activities enhance CPD's existing programs.

Full Spectrum is one free program in five parts; each starts only when funded and scheduled with park staff. (a) DJ classes: 14 weekly 90-minute sessions for ages 5 to adult (Guinness named DJ Arch Jnr the world's youngest club DJ at 5), gear provided, including a girls-only Empress Decks track taught by women DJs. (b) Rainbow Wednesdays: 14 free summer evenings of youth DJs and live instruments on the beach. (c) Live stage shows where young performers open for local and major artists. (d) Festival and heritage days, including Black History Month: all ages research history with AI, write songs, and DJs mix them into one set. (e) Fall, holiday and Valentine's parties, October to February. It adds evening and off-season arts programming at the park and gives young people a path from class to stage. Full proposal attached.

How are you or your organization qualified to lead these activities? 50 Words or Less.

Ras Tafari Inc. produces SelassieFest, Chicago's roots reggae and cultural festival, end to end: artist contracting, staging, sound, permits, insurance and marketing. Classes follow a written 14-session curriculum taught by experienced Chicago DJs, with professional sound from Q-Ality Sound under a vendor agreement.

Is this partnership a collaboration with an existing CPD program? If yes explain. 50 Words or Less.

Not yet formally. We would welcome linking Full Spectrum to Rainbow Beach Park's youth and teen programs, with class graduates DJing park events, day camp celebrations and holiday programs.

Describe the evidence of community demand for the proposed partnership. 50 Words or Less.

Interest in learning to DJ is rising: Pioneer DJ reported higher sales of its beginner controllers from 2020, and the DJ-gear market grows about 6 to 7% a year. South Shore families travel nine miles to Grant Park concerts. We will track registrations, Open Decks sign-ups and head counts.

Are you willing to offer programming at additional park location(s)? (●) Yes ( ) No

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Projected Number of Participants: 50+ youth

Gender(s): All genders; reserved seats for girls

Ages (Select all that apply.)

Early Childhood	Adults
Youth	Families
Teens	Seniors

Race/Ethnicity (Select all that apply): General Audience

Income levels (Select all that apply): General Audience

Community Area(s)

Avalon Park	South Chicago
Calumet Heights	South Shore
Greater Grand Crossing	Woodlawn

Veterans (●) Yes ( ) No

Disability (●) Yes ( ) No

LGBTQ (●) Yes ( ) No

Please review the ARCS Guidelines for details about required benefits for the partner type you are applying for and describe the benefits in detail that you are able to provide for the Chicago Park District.

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES (Include number of days, number of volunteers, and number of hours)

Rainbow Wednesdays: at least 2 volunteers each night for 14 nights, about 4 hours each (Open Decks sign-up, accessibility help, cleanup), alongside paid crew. Festival days and parties: volunteer crews sized per event. Every adult who works with young people passes CPD's volunteer background check.

IN-KIND SERVICES & CONTRIBUTIONS (Please discuss with Park Supervisor.) Include specifics such as number of service hours for park programs or field maintenance, etc.

Free classes and events for park patrons; program-owned DJ controllers, headphones and professional sound at no cost to the park; class students available to DJ park events on request; sites left cleaner than we found them.

OTHER BENEFITS

Year-round use of the park, including the off-season; a focus on girls, who hold under 6% of Hot 100 producer credits (USC Annenberg, 2024); veterans outreach led by board member and veteran Albert Harris; LGBTQ+ youth and families invited by name; ASL, accessible seating and a quieter zone; $1M general liability naming CPD; background checks for all adults working with youth; a season report to the park with attendance, performers and audience reach.

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS:

-Proof of insurance (required)
-References, Letters of Recommendation
-Certifications and proof of affiliation (letterhead, business card, etc.)
-Proof of nonprofit status
-Permit request
-Proposed schedule of activities with detailed descriptions
-Other:

SUBMIT COMPLETED APPLICATIONS TO
PARTNERSHIPS.APP@CHICAGOPARKDISTRICT.COM

PLEASE NOTE:

We will consider partnerships for parks across the city, but prioritize partnerships that support parks with specific programming needs as determined internally by the Chicago Park District. Please note that for ongoing partnerships, proposals must be submitted at least annually, unless partnership agreements allow for longer terms.

Ideal partnerships show an equal financial and programmatic impact on both the Chicago Park District and our partners. A series of events may be considered as part of a partnership agreement, but one-time events are not eligible for the ARCS program.